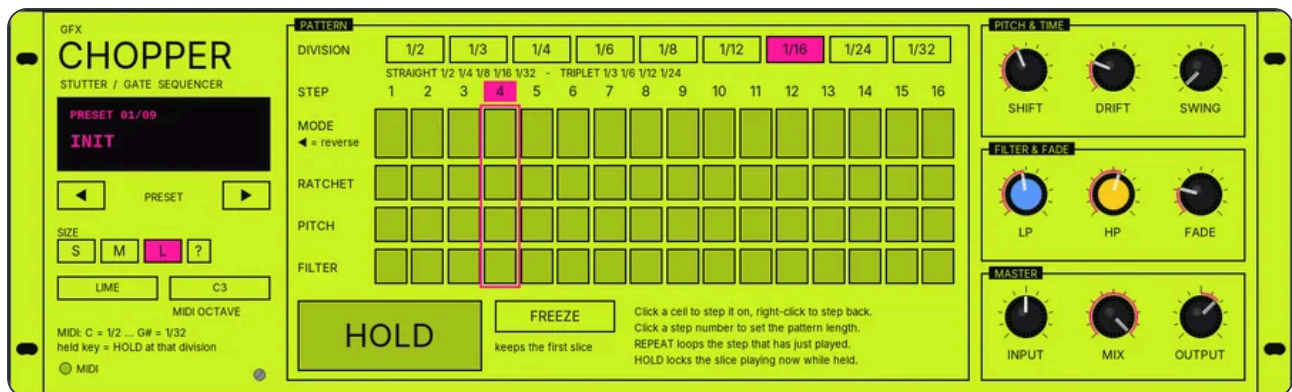


Chopper

A tempo-synced stutter and gate sequencer for vocal chops, beat-repeats and trance gating.



Overview

Chopper records your audio all the time and plays it back through a pattern of up to 16 steps, locked to the project tempo. Each step either lets the live sound through, repeats the slice that has just played, plays that slice backwards, or mutes it. That covers stutter-house vocal chops, beat-repeat rolls and the classic trance gate in one panel.

Every step can also be ratcheted (the slice restarts 2, 3 or 4 times inside the step), pitched up, and filtered. A short FADE window at every edge of every slice means nothing clicks.

HOLD (or a key on your MIDI keyboard) locks whatever is playing now and repeats it at the current division - the 'stutter' button of a DJ effect. Chopper follows the transport; when it is stopped the pattern runs on at the project tempo.

Reach for it for

- Stutter-house and pop vocal chops
- Beat-repeat rolls and fills into the next bar
- Trance-style rhythmic gating of pads and chords
- Reverse swells on the off-beats
- Live stutter performance from a MIDI keyboard

Controls

Left panel

Display	Shows the preset number and name. While you touch a control it shows that control and its value for a moment; while HOLD is down it shows HOLD (or MIDI HOLD) and the division. Click it to open the preset list.
PRESETS	Also opens the preset list.
◀ / ▶	Step to the previous or next preset.
SIZE: S / M / L	Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also shrinks to fit the plugin window.
?	Opens a pop-up with the design credit, a short guide to the pattern and the GFX website address. Click anywhere to close it.
LIME / MAGENTA	Switches the faceplate between acid lime (black print, magenta lights) and hot magenta (white print, cyan lights).
MIDI OCTAVE	Click to choose the octave that triggers HOLD from MIDI: C1, C2, C3, C4 or C5 (middle C = C4). The display shows the range of keys, e.g. C3 - G#3.
MIDI light	Lights while a trigger key is held.

PATTERN

DIVISION	The length of each step: 1/2, 1/3, 1/4, 1/6, 1/8, 1/12, 1/16, 1/24 or 1/32 of a bar. 1/3, 1/6, 1/12 and 1/24 are triplets.
STEP numbers	Click a step number to set the pattern length (1 to 16 steps). Steps past the length are dimmed. The playing step is lit and outlined.
MODE	What the step does. Dark: THRU, the live sound. Lit: REPEAT, the slice that has just played is looped. Lit with ◀: REVERSE, the slice played backwards. Black with x: MUTE.

RATCHET	x1 to x4: the slice is shortened and restarted 2, 3 or 4 times inside the step, for rolls.
PITCH	Off, UP (raised by the SHIFT knob, shown as +5 etc.) or +12 (an octave up). The slice plays faster to raise its pitch.
FILTER	Off, LP (low-pass, set by the LP knob) or HP (high-pass, set by the HP knob). The change is smoothed so it never zips.

Click a cell to step it forward, right-click to step it back. RATCHET, PITCH and FILTER work on repeated and reversed steps; FILTER also works on live (THRU) steps.

HOLD	Momentary: while you hold the mouse down on it, the slice playing now (one division long) is locked and repeated at the current division, with the pitch and filter of the moment. Let go and the pattern carries on.
FREEZE	Keeps the first slice it catches: every REPEAT and REVERSE step then replays that same slice instead of catching a new one. Switching it on catches a fresh slice; a silent slice is never kept.

PITCH & TIME

SHIFT	How far UP steps are raised, 0 to +12 semitones (+5 by default).
DRIFT	See Drift below.
SWING	0 - 50%. Makes the first step of each pair longer and the second shorter, for a shuffled feel.

FILTER & FADE

LP (blue cap)	The cutoff of the low-pass used by LP steps, 100 Hz - 20 kHz (1.2 kHz by default).
HP (yellow cap)	The cutoff of the high-pass used by HP steps, 20 Hz - 8 kHz (600 Hz by default).
FADE	The fade at the start and end of every slice, 1 - 10 ms (3 ms by default). Shorter is snappier; longer is smoother if you

hear clicks on bass-heavy material.

Drift

DRIFT

Only the repeated and reversed slices are affected: they wander slowly in pitch (up to a quarter of a semitone at 100%), and each new slice gets its own small offset, like tape. The live sound and the timing are never touched. 0 - 100%, 25% by default.

MASTER

INPUT

The level into Chopper, -24 to +24 dB.

MIX

Dry / chopped balance. 100% (the default) is the chopped signal only; lower settings blend the untouched input back in.

OUTPUT

Output level, -24 to +12 dB.

Knobs: drag up and down (Shift for fine control) or use the mouse wheel; double-click or Ctrl-click to reset. The value shows while you hover.

Presets

A preset sets every control, including the pattern, INPUT, MIX and OUTPUT; only MIDI OCTAVE is left as it is.

Init

All 16 steps live (THRU) at 1/16: a blank pattern to start from.

Lavern Gate

Chopped 1/16 repeats with gaps, and a ratchet roll into the next bar.

Breathless 16ths

Every 1/16 step repeats, the off-beats lifted a fifth (SHIFT +7), ending on a roll up an octave.

Triplet Flutter

12 steps of 1/24 triplets over two beats: repeats with gaps, a few lifted, a roll at the end.

Underwater Build	Low-passed repeats that roll faster and faster and rise in pitch at the end.
Reverse Swell	1/8 steps over one bar: live and backwards in turn, then three reversed steps to finish, the last one doubled.
Half-Time Freeze	FREEZE on: one caught slice replayed quarter by quarter, the last one doubled and lifted.
24th Roll	12 steps of 1/24: live for half the pattern, then repeats that roll faster and rise, high-passed at the end.
Trance Pulse	The classic gate on the live sound, with a little swing and two high-passed steps.

Triggering HOLD from MIDI

One octave of keys holds the slice at each division, rising: C 1/2, C# 1/3, D 1/4, D# 1/6, E 1/8, F 1/12, F# 1/16, G 1/24, G# 1/32. Holding a key locks the slice and repeats it at that key's division; let go and the pattern carries on (if another trigger key is still held, it takes over). All MIDI passes through Chopper unchanged.

1. Put Chopper on the track with the audio you want to chop.
2. Get MIDI to that track: add a MIDI item on the same track, or arm the track with your MIDI keyboard as its input, or send MIDI to it from another track.
3. Click MIDI OCTAVE until it shows the octave you want to play in (the display shows the range of keys).
4. Hold the keys in that octave while the music plays; the MIDI light and the display show MIDI HOLD and the division.

Tips

- For a beat-repeat fill, leave most of the bar on THRU and set only the last few steps to REPEAT with rising RATCHET.
- Use MIX below 100% for a subtler stutter that keeps the original phrase underneath.

- For a trance gate on a pad, use THRU and MUTE steps only at 1/16, with a little SWING.
- If repeats click on bass or kick-heavy material, raise FADE to 5 - 8 ms.
- Turn DRIFT to 0% when the repeats must stay exactly in tune with the track.

File: gfx-chopper.jsfx